clearly answer the questions of whom, how and where to protect. Namely, modern migrations or even modern refugees are by no means (only) the result of classical persecution (as defined above), but are fleeing for survival or because their countries of origin have disintegrated or failed, or even because of the effects of climate change. The two authors are particularly critical of the established model of refugee camps, as they often become a lasting solution to keeping refugees away from the countries that fund them.[127]

The migration wave of 2015, triggered also by Russia's military intervention in Syria's civil war, led to more than 4 million Syrians fleeing to neighbouring Jordan, Turkey and Lebanon. These – not exactly rich countries – have been exposed to an extraordinary burden, which neither the OECD (Organisation for Economic Cooperation and Development) members nor their rich Arab OPEC (Organisation of the Petroleum Exporting Countries) neighbours have been able or willing to finance. The UNHCR (United Nations High Commission for Refugees) has provided refugees in these countries with relative security, food and shelter, but they still faced unemployment without any real prospects. Many soon became aware of the proximity of the 'Greek Lampedusa' – the island of Lesbos, from where continental Europe can be reached.

In August 2015, the Syrian regime's military position deteriorated again, so Russia had to come to the rescue. Germany's decision to open the door to refugees even beyond the provisions of the common European migration system was, inadvertently, an additional impetus to the Syrian population in areas where Assad was aided by the Russian military. Betts and Collier suggest that the Russian president actually had his reasons for encouraging such an exodus to Germany. Migrations can indeed be misused as a geopolitical and/or international security tool.

The migration wave of 2015/16 was really something special, a novelty and something inconceivable even for diplomats and consular officials. For years, from their first consular training, diplomats have been instilled with the idea of respecting strict EU rules related to security and sovereignty, and with the basic postulates that every person from a country with a visa requirement is subject to security and migration checks. Diplomats (and border police officers) could only hold their breath as countries, in the midst of the migration crisis in the autumn and winter of 2015, allowed people to